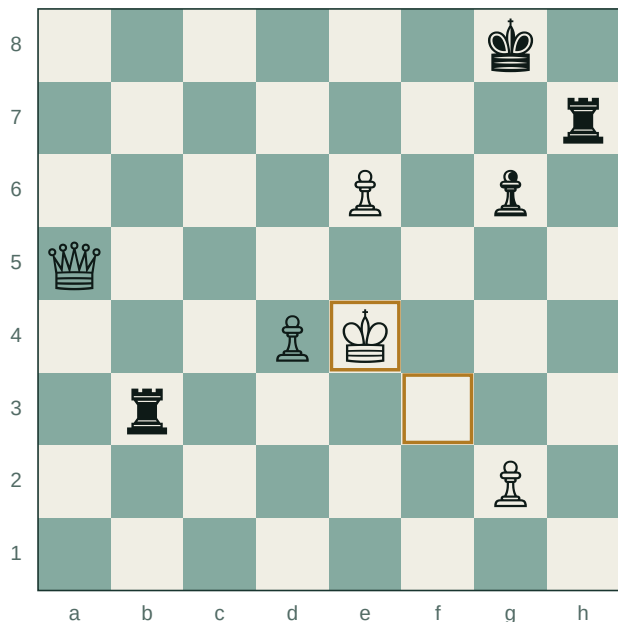


# Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 51

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 51.Ke4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**51...Rh4+ 52. Kd5 Rh5+ 53. Kc4 Rxa5**

**51...Rh4+** Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **52.Kd5**.

**52...Rh5+** Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **53.Kc4**.

**53...Rxa5** The rook captures the queen on a5.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -1 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on e4. Geometrically undefended: queen on a5. Check for tactical protection.